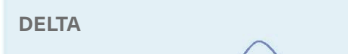


Q DOES YOGA NIDRA PROVIDE THE SAME BENEFITS AS SLEEP?

Although it does seem to offer many of the same rejuvenating benefits, yoga nidra does not

replace sleep. However, it does produce brain wave patterns similar to those of sleep (see below).

Brain frequency chart

BRAINWAVE	SLEEP STAGE	YOGA NIDRA STAGE	LEVEL OF CONSCIOUSNESS	CHARACTERISTICS
GAMMA 	Fully awake	Not nidra	Conscious	High alertness (not well understood)
BETA 	Fully awake	Initially when transitioning into the practice	Conscious	Thinking and talking
ALPHA 	First stage of sleep	During body scan and relaxation	Conscious—gateway to the subconscious	Relaxation
THETA 	Next stage of sleep	May be reached, likely later in the practice	Subconscious	Creative problem solving
DELTA 	Deep dreamless sleep	May be reached but there is little to no evidence of this	Unconscious	Rejuvenation and intuition

Q LYING FLAT ON MY BACK IS UNCOMFORTABLE. WHAT CAN I DO?

Many people find Savasana uncomfortable, particularly for their backs. Try using a support under your knees or lying in a constructive rest position—raising your knees and placing the soles of your feet on the floor—to relieve tension in your lower back. This can also help stop you from falling asleep.

MYTH-BUSTER

Savasana prevents lactic acid buildup.

No. Lactic acid, a waste product from muscle engagement, is broken down and removed by your liver within minutes after exertion.

To reduce soreness, build the intensity of your asana practice over time. You can also rest the sore muscles by doing a more restorative class or working different muscle groups.